

TRANSITION OS · COMPANION WORKBOOK

The workbook.

Ninety days of the thinking that does not fit in a text box. A page for every lesson worth writing by hand.

Seven modules. About four hours of writing, spread over three months. Nobody reads this but you.

0 Start ☐	1 Ground ☐	2 Explore ☐	3 Connect ☐	4 Translate ☐	5 Test ☐	6 Leap ☐	7 After ☐
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Name

Started on

How to use this

Three rules, and one from me.

- Do the lesson on screen first, then the page here. The screen version has the calculators and the animations; this is where you say what you actually think.
- Write badly. Fragments, half-sentences, a list. The box is for thinking, not for prose. If you find yourself drafting, you've switched into work mode, and this isn't work.
- Come back. Every page has a date line. The answers change, and the difference between the first and the third pass is the useful part.

And mine: I filled in a version of these pages in 2019 with a pen, in a car, before a shift. Most of what I wrote was wrong, and it still got me out. Wrong answers you've written down are worth more than right answers you're still thinking about.

WHAT'S IN HERE

Modules 0 and 1 Ground: permission, the decision, the dials	
Module 2 Explore: twenty paths, and the ones you try on	
Module 3 Connect: who to find, and what to say to them	
Module 4 Translate: your words into theirs	
Module 5 Test: proof, and the money	
Module 6 Leap: interviews and the offer	
Module 7 After: your story, and the next rung	

MODULES 0 AND 1 IN DETAIL

0.1 Welcome What you want, in one line	
0.2 Your starting line Stage, income floor, date	
0.3 Three things I believed Which of the three you hold	
1.1 You're allowed to want out Your stage, your belief, your move	
1.2 Bad workplace, bad fit, bad season? Six questions and a verdict	
1.3 The sunk-cost audit Spent vs. still live	
1.4 What actually gave you energy Energisers and drainers	
1.5 What you can't afford to lose Four dials, three paths	
1.6 What you keep when you leave What goes with you	
1.7 Tell one person Who, when, what they said	
1.8 Checkpoint One sentence in pull language	

MODULE 0 · LESSON 1 · 3 MIN

Welcome

Before the map, one honest line.

If this program works, what is different on a Tuesday in December? Not the title. The day.

Where you are at 8am. What you're not doing. Who you talk to. What time you close the laptop.

What have you already tried? Settings, hours, a different district, a course, a coach. List them, with roughly what each one cost you.

What's the thing you'd be embarrassed to admit you want? Write it here. Nobody's reading.

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

MODULE 0 · LESSON 2 · 5 MIN

Your starting line

Five answers. Everything after this bends around them.

1. Which of these sounds most like right now?

- ☐ I haven't told anyone I'm thinking about this.
- ☐ I feel guilty even looking. The degree, the loans, the people I'd leave.
- ☐ I keep reading exit stories and wondering if it's really possible.
- ☐ I want out. I just don't know what else I could do.
- ☐ I know what I want. I'm applying and not getting traction.

2. A path, if you have one

Optional. Nothing needs it until Module 2; the mindset, résumé, LinkedIn and networking lessons work for any title. A path only changes which examples, postings and artifact brief you see.

Path, or "not sure yet"	
Why that one, in ten words	

3. Your income floor

- ☐ Must match my SLP pay from day one
- ☐ I can take a small dip for better conditions
- ☐ I have runway for a bigger jump

The number underneath the box you ticked. What's the monthly figure below which this stops being a choice?

4. Target date

The date I want to be in a new role Ninety days out is the default. Fast paths fit inside it; long builds run 6–15 months.	
What has to be true by then	

MODULE 0 · LESSON 3 · 3 MIN

Three things I believed

I held all three. Tick the ones you hold.

- ☐ "I'd have to start over."
- ☐ "I need a certificate first."
- ☐ "I'd be throwing away my degree."

Pick the one you ticked hardest. Where did it come from? A person, a post, a professor, a number?

What has believing it cost you so far? Months, applications not sent, a conversation not had.

"I know it's the sunken cost fallacy but it's so hard to quit after putting so much time, money, and effort into this career." an SLP on r/slp

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

1

MODULE 1 • WEEK 1

Ground

Before you look at a single job title, work out which problem you actually have. Three people with the same exhaustion need three different fixes, and picking the wrong one costs a year.

THE PAGES IN THIS MODULE

- Your stage, and the belief underneath it
- Bad workplace, bad fit, or bad season
- The sunk-cost audit
- What gave you energy, and what took it
- Four dials, and what you cannot afford to lose
- What you keep when you leave
- Telling one person
- The checkpoint: two lists and one sentence

WHAT YOU WILL HAVE AT THE END

A verdict in one word, and one sentence about where you are going that you did not have in week one.

Started this module on

Finished on

MODULE 1 · LESSON 1 · 6 MIN

You're allowed to want out

Five stages. Find yours, then name the belief in your own words.

1 Private doubt "Looking means deciding."	
2 Guilt and identity "Leaving wastes the degree."	
3 Permission-seeking "It works for other people, not me."	
4 Practical panic "I'd have to start over at the bottom."	
5 Action "If I were good enough, I'd get callbacks."	

Tick the row you're in. Then:

The belief that keeps you at this stage, in your own words. Not the lesson's version. Yours.

The one move for your stage (from the lesson), and when this week you'll do it.

Which stage were you in six months ago? What moved you?

"Maybe it's just a problem with my brain and not the job." a school SLP, r/slp

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

MODULE 1 · LESSON 2 · 8 MIN

Bad workplace, bad fit, or bad season?

"I want to quit" is three problems wearing one trench coat.

If the conditions were decent (a fair caseload, real documentation time, a manager who backs you), would the clinical work itself still light you up? Yes / No / Not sure	
Have you already changed settings and had the feeling follow you? Yes / No	
Is something outside work taking most of what you've got right now? Yes / No	
Would any job feel impossible this month, even a good one? Yes / No	
Are you more interested in the data, the training, the coordination or the tech around therapy than in the therapy itself? Yes / No	
Is the thing draining you a specific person, building, or productivity number? Yes / No	

Your verdict

- ☐ Bad workplace: the profession might be fine and the setting is not.
- ☐ Bad fit: the conditions could be perfect and I'd still feel it.
- ☐ Bad season: life outside work is taking everything I've got.

The settings experiment. List every setting or employer you've tried, and whether the feeling came with you.

Changing settings is the advice every exit thread gets. Having run it three times is data.

What you do first, given the verdict. One sentence.

"I've worked in several settings so can't imagine a setting change is the answer. It's all the same story, different font." r/slp

MODULE 1 · LESSON 3 · 7 MIN

The sunk-cost audit

The degree is spent either way. Only the next years are still live.

Already spent (the same whether you stay or go)

Years in the field	
Student debt remaining	
What the degree cost, roughly ASHA, 2024: SLP master's programs run \$23,000 to \$75,000.	

Still live

Current salary BLS median for SLPs, May 2025: \$97,870. Middle half: \$77,730 to \$114,570.	
Target path and its documented range	
Months I expect the move to take Typical: 6 to 15.	
Ten-year total if I stay From the on-screen calculator.	
Ten-year total if I move	
The difference	

Now the part the calculator can't do. When you think about the money, what's the story underneath? Whose salary are you comparing yours to?

In the forums the comparison is almost always a spouse, a sibling, or a friend with PTO, not a number.

If you're on PSLF or income-driven repayment: how many qualifying payments are left, and who would you need to ask to be sure?

Module 5 covers the loan as a calendar. Write what you know now.

"Sometimes a pay cut is worth sanity... and it may only be temporary anyway."

r/SLPcareertransitions

Why the tuition feels refundable: Arkes and Blumer (1985) gave theatre-goers randomly discounted season tickets. The people who paid full price went to more plays, because of what they had already spent. The money was gone either way.

MODULE 1 · LESSON 4 · 8 MIN

What actually gave you energy

Competence and energy are different things. This page is about the second one.

Work through your last month. For each task, mark whether it gave you energy or took it, and ignore whether you are good at it.

Direct therapy sessions Gave / Took	
Evaluations and report writing Gave / Took	
IEP or care-plan meetings Gave / Took	
Progress notes and documentation Gave / Took	
Parent and family conversations Gave / Took	
Supervising CFs or students Gave / Took	
Training colleagues or staff Gave / Took	
Data collection and progress monitoring Gave / Took	
Choosing or trialling AAC and devices Gave / Took	
Learning a new system or platform Gave / Took	

Anything else that took up real time last month, and which column it belongs in.

Now the harder question. Which of the draining ones are you actually good at? Those are the tasks a career quietly gets built on.

Look at the two columns and name the pattern in your own words. Not "working with people", which is too vague. Working with whom, on what, under what conditions?

MODULE 1 · LESSON 5 · 8 MIN

What you can't afford to lose

Four dials, five boxes each. Tick where you are this month, not where you'd like to be.

Pay floor

☐ I have runway	☐ A dip is fine for a while	☐ Roughly the same	☐ Must match now	☐ Must beat it
---	---	--	--	--

Distance from clinical

☐ Clean break	☐ Mostly out	☐ Adjacent	☐ Close to it	☐ Inside it
---	--	--------------------------------------	---	---------------------------------------

Live people-time

☐ As little as possible	☐ A few calls a day	☐ Half my day	☐ Most of my day	☐ Still love 1:1
---	---	---	--	--

New tools and software

☐ Rather work with people	☐ Learn as needed	☐ Comfortable	☐ Enjoy learning them	☐ Colleagues come to me
---	---	---	---	---

Path 1 (from the on-screen ranking)	
Path 2	
Path 3	

Which dial surprised you? Which one did you set where you think you should be, and then move?

The dial you'd be most ashamed to admit is set the way it is. Why that one?

MODULE 1 · LESSON 6 · 5 MIN

What you keep when you leave

Caitlin, Lindsey and Bethany kept the thing they were good at. The title was the only casualty.

The part of the work you'd keep if you could keep only one thing. Explaining hard things simply? Holding a room to a plan? Reading the data? Building trust with skeptics? Be specific: a moment, a person, a session.

The part you wouldn't miss for a second.

Of the three stories, whose starting point looks most like yours, and what did they do in the first month?

Skip the last month. The last month is always the offer letter.

"I've taken a long time to grieve the loss of who I was in my previous role." a comment on a former SLP's essay about leaving

If it's grief, what are you grieving? Write the sentence that starts "I'll miss being the person who..."

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MODULE 1 · LESSON 7 · 3 MIN

Tell one person

The smallest possible disclosure. It costs less than the secret does.

Who (someone who won't argue)	
When	
The sentence "I'm looking at what else I could do with my SLP background."	

How it went. What they said, what your face did, what you felt an hour later.

If they push back

Two replies show up in every forum thread about leaving. Write yours now so they don't cost you anything later.

"Have you tried a different setting?" My reply:	
"There's a shortage. This makes it worse." My reply:	

"Posting here because I don't have the energy for the replies and shaming that I anticipate would come from r/slp." [r/SLPcareertransitions](#)

MODULE 1 · CHECKPOINT · 2 MIN

Checkpoint: Ground

Two lists, then one sentence. The sentence only works if you have written the honest version first.

01 I want to leave or change my situation because...

The frictions pushing you. Be exhaustive and unpolished. "My caseload went to 68 in October and nobody mentioned it" is more use than "workload issues".

List them all. Six or eight is normal.

02 I want my next chapter to give me...

The outcomes pulling you. Concrete again: "control over when I do focused work" beats "flexibility".

List them all.

MODULE 1 · CHECKPOINT

Your definition of progress

Circle the two or three on each list that carry the most weight, then write them here.

Moving away from, 1	
Moving away from, 2	
Moving away from, 3	
Moving toward, 1	
Moving toward, 2	
Moving toward, 3	

Two people can write the same push and need opposite things. That is why the sentence below is yours rather than a category. The pushes-and-pulls framing comes from the Jobs to Be Done work of Bob Moesta and Clayton Christensen.

Where I landed this week

My stage	
My verdict Bad workplace / bad fit / bad season	
What gave me energy, in a phrase	
The three paths my dials pointed at	

In one sentence, the progress I am looking for is... Where you are going, not what you are escaping. No burnout words.

It becomes the first line of your cover letter, your LinkedIn About, and your answer to "why are you leaving clinical work?"

"Examples of pull: "I want to work at the scale of a system instead of one room." "I want to build the training instead of deliver it." "I want to use what I know about clinicians to make a product they will actually use.""

Read it aloud. Would a hiring manager hear a retention risk, or a plan? Rewrite once if it is the first.

Notes to the person reading this in three months

What do you want them to remember about how this week felt?

Date: ____ / ____ / ____

2

MODULE 2 · WEEKS 2 AND 3

Explore

Twenty paths, with what each one pays and how long it took the people who did it. This module is for trying several on, not for choosing.

THE PAGES IN THIS MODULE

- Twenty paths, tried on
- A Tuesday in the role, in your own words
- The requirement you meet, and the one you do not

WHAT YOU WILL HAVE AT THE END

Two or three paths you can describe out loud, and one you are curious enough to test first.

Started this module on

Finished on

MODULE 2 · LESSON 1

Twenty paths, tried on

The screen ranks them. This page is where you argue with the ranking.

Which three paths did the map and the dials put in front of you, and what was your gut reaction to each?

Gut reactions are data here. A path you dismissed in half a second is worth a sentence about why.

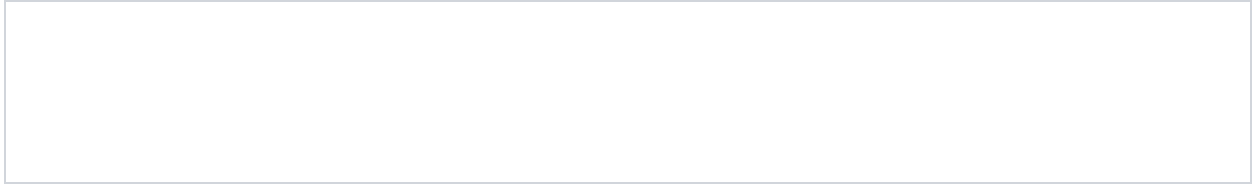
Which one are you choosing to explore first, and what would have to be true for it to be wrong?

What the day actually looks like

From the deep-dive and from any postings you read. Write it in your own words, not theirs.

A Tuesday in this role, in four sentences.

Which requirement on the postings do you already meet, and which one is a genuine gap?



3

MODULE 3 · WEEKS 3 TO 5

Connect

Your contact list is almost entirely SLPs, which is why nobody in it can refer you. This module is about finding the people who already hold the title you want, and what to say to them.

THE PAGES IN THIS MODULE

- Three names, and where you found them
- Three messages, and what came back
- The follow-up log

WHAT YOU WILL HAVE AT THE END

Three names, three messages sent, and at least one conversation with somebody who already holds the title.

Started this module on

Finished on

MODULE 3 · LESSON 1

Three names

Before the messages, the names. This page is the search, written down.

The two groups you asked to join

They are closed and unsearchable, which is why you have not found them before. Request today, forget about it, and note the date so you know when to chase.

Group 1 Requested on	
Group 2 Requested on	

Where the people are

The subreddit for your target title Not for your profession	
The community for that field Association, Slack, or forum	
A company from the 120 list Search it with CCC-SLP	

The three names

A former SLP who now holds the title, anyone else with the title, and someone at a company on your list.

Name 1, and their title now Where you found them	
Name 2, and their title now Where you found them	
Name 3, and their title now Where you found them	

MODULE 3 · LESSON 3

Three messages

The reach-out is the first thing that involves another person. Plan it here.

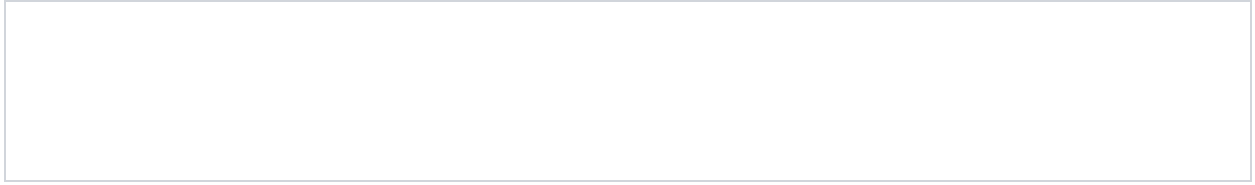
Person 1: who, and where you found them	
What made you pick them	
Sent on	
Reply	

Person 2: who, and where you found them	
What made you pick them	
Sent on	
Reply	

Person 3: who, and where you found them	
What made you pick them	
Sent on	
Reply	

If someone replies and gives you twenty minutes, what are the three things you most want to know?

Not what the job pays. Things only a person in the seat can tell you.



About one in four of these gets no answer. That is the rate, not a verdict.

MODULE 3 · LESSON 7

The follow-up log

One follow-up, eight days later, and it has to add something. There is no second one.

Person Sent on	
What I added in the follow-up Due on	
Answer, or closed	

Person Sent on	
What I added in the follow-up Due on	
Answer, or closed	

Person Sent on	
What I added in the follow-up Due on	
Answer, or closed	

Which of these went quiet, and what is the most likely boring reason?

Frozen reqs, a full pipeline, a holiday. It is almost never about you.

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4

MODULE 4 · WEEKS 5 TO 7

Translate

The work is already done. What is missing is the sentence that lets a hiring manager see it, which is a vocabulary problem rather than an experience one.

THE PAGES IN THIS MODULE

- Your numbers, pulled from the calendar you already keep
- Three bullets, rewritten by hand
- The paragraph only you could write

WHAT YOU WILL HAVE AT THE END

A résumé a hiring manager can read in seven seconds, and one application sent properly.

Started this module on

Finished on

MODULE 4 · LESSON 3

The same work, their words

The tool does the bulk translation. This page holds the two or three that need your judgement.

Your numbers

Pulled from the number-mining tool, or from memory. Estimates are fine; bracket anything you need to confirm.

Largest caseload	
People trained or supervised	
Meetings led in a month	
Systems rolled out or changed	
Sites covered	
One outcome you moved, before and after	

MODULE 4 · LESSON 2

Three bullets, rewritten by hand

One line as it reads today. One line as it should read.

Bullet 1, today:

Bullet 1, translated:

Bullet 2, today:

Bullet 2, translated:

Bullet 3, today:

Bullet 3, translated:

MODULE 4 · LESSON 6

The paragraph only you could write

Every cover letter has one. It is the reason the letter costs you something.

Write it. The specific thing about this company, this product or this problem that made you apply. If you could send the paragraph to any employer unchanged, it is not the one.

Read it back. Which sentence would a teacher leaving the classroom also be able to send? Cross it out and replace it.

5

MODULE 5 • WEEKS 7 TO 9

Test

One thing you make, and the three numbers that decide whether you can afford the move. This is the module where the plan meets the bank account.

THE PAGES IN THIS MODULE

- The thing you make, planned so the week does not eat it
- The three numbers: loans, coverage, runway

WHAT YOU WILL HAVE AT THE END

One thing you made that a stranger can look at, and three numbers you have actually worked out.

Started this module on

Finished on

MODULE 5 · LESSON 2

The thing you make

One artifact, two sessions, a process note. Plan it here so the week does not eat it.

What I am making	
Session 1, ninety minutes: date	
Session 2, ninety minutes: date	
Where it will live	

The process note. What was the problem, what did you decide, and what would you do differently? Three or four sentences, written after it exists.

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MODULE 5 · LESSON 5

The three numbers

Loans, coverage, runway. Fill these in with real figures, not remembered ones.

Forgiveness, if it applies

Qualifying payments made so far Check your federal loan account, do not estimate	
Payments remaining	
Does my employer qualify? Look it up in the official employer search	
Last time I filed the certification form	

Coverage

Who covers me now, and until when	
COBRA cost per month, if offered Up to 102% of the full premium	
Marketplace estimate for my expected income	
Gap I would need to bridge, in weeks	

Runway

Savings I would use	
Monthly income I would give up	
Monthly gap, all in	
Months of runway Savings divided by the monthly gap	
Months I expect the move to take Documented: 6 to 15	

If the runway is shorter than the move, which lever are you pulling: a smaller dip, a shorter bridge, or a fast-exit path first?

6

MODULE 6 • WEEKS 9 TO 12

Leap

Career changers get screened out for three specific reasons, and none of them is that you cannot do the job. This module is the answers, said aloud until they stop sounding rehearsed.

THE PAGES IN THIS MODULE

- Your bridge statement, in three parts
- The questions, and the number you decided in advance

WHAT YOU WILL HAVE AT THE END

A bridge statement you can say without flinching, and a number you decided before anyone asked.

Started this module on

Finished on

MODULE 6 · LESSON 2

Your bridge statement

Three parts, said aloud until it stops sounding rehearsed.

Pull: where you are going. Copy it from the Module 1 checkpoint, or improve it now.

Preparation: what you have done to get ready. The artifact, the conversations, the certificate.

Proof: one accomplishment with a real number, mapped onto a problem this role has in its first ninety days.

Tick each time you say the whole thing out loud: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

MODULE 6 · LESSONS 3 AND 5

The questions and the number

Two things to have decided before an interview, rather than during one.

Which screening question would you fumble today? Write your answer, then cut it in half.

Your number

Documented range for my path	
The number I will say if asked first	
My walk-away number Below this, the runway maths fails	
What I would ask for if the base is fixed Sign-on, PTO, remote days, an early review	

Say the counter out loud once, to a person. Who did you say it to, and how did it sound?

ACROSS MODULES 3 TO 6

The tracker

Two conversations and a ratio. The spreadsheet does the arithmetic; this page is for the part it cannot hold.

Download the three-sheet tracker from the course dashboard and import it into Google Sheets or Notion. Use this page for the thinking behind the rows.

People

Who I am trying to reach, and why them	
Messages sent so far	
Replies About one in four gets no answer	
Conversations had	
Names I was given This column is where a network comes from	

The most useful thing anyone has told me so far, and what I did about it.

Applications

Applications sent	
Screens	
Interviews	
Offers	
My ratio, so far 113 to 7 to 1 is one documented transition	

Which stage is actually broken? Applications without screens is a résumé problem, screens without interviews is a bridge-statement problem, interviews without offers is usually a proof problem.

What I am changing this week because of that.

7

MODULE 7 · ALUMNI

After

What changes once you are in, and what you owe the person who is where you were a year ago.

THE PAGES IN THIS MODULE

- Six months in
- The message you answer

WHAT YOU WILL HAVE AT THE END

Your story written down, and one message answered for somebody a year behind you.

Started this module on

Finished on

MODULE 7 · LESSON 2

Six months in

Come back to this page when you are on the other side.

What is different on a Tuesday now? Compare it with what you wrote on the very first page.

What did you worry about that turned out not to matter?

What would you tell the person who is where you were in week one?

That last answer is your story. The form is at slptransitions.com/about.

You did the whole thing.

Whatever the title says now, you are still the person who can explain hard things simply, hold a room to a plan, and read a page of data and know what to do next. That was never the job. That was you.